

PADMASHREE

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FP&A Analyst · MS in Finance · Chartered Accountant (CPA Equivalent) · Open to Relocation

SUMMARY

FP&A analyst in manufacturing and operations finance. Most recently supported the Production organization at Harbinger Motors, an EV manufacturer, through a US production ramp, building the cost models and decision-making tools operations leaders used for resource planning while processes were still being invented. Five years of finance experience underneath it: two-plus years of full-cycle FP&A at NTT DATA, a multinational, analyzing KPIs across revenue, cost of sales, operating expenses (OpEx), and capital expenditures (CapEx), building financial forecasts, and managing headcount planning and resource management for four business functions, plus three years as a Chartered Accountant preparing and interpreting complete financial statements. Works fast in an ambiguous environment, investigates to root cause before escalating, and communicates conclusions to senior business leaders in plain language. Uses AI tools daily and builds them into the work: AI-assisted automation I initiated cut close and reporting cycle time by 25% and reconciliation discrepancies by 30%.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Manufacturing and Operations Finance: Cost of sales and cost per unit analysis, direct and indirect labor, material consumption and inventory movements, freight and logistics costs, scrap and quality cost quantification, manufacturing cost improvement focus areas, production planning support, capacity and utilization tracking, cost models as decision-making tools for operations leaders.

Financial Planning and Analysis: KPI analysis across revenue, cost of sales, operating expenses, and capital expenditures; financial modeling and forecasting; annual budgets and rolling financial forecasts; headcount planning and resource management; budget vs actual variance analysis with driver commentary; scenario analysis and business cases for investment decisions; long-range planning.

Financial Statements and Accounting: Chartered Accountant (CPA equivalent); prepare, read, and interpret P&L, Balance Sheet, and Cash Flow financial statements; US GAAP and IFRS; month-end close; reconciliations; audit and internal controls foundation.

Tools and AI: Advanced Microsoft Excel and Microsoft Office (financial models, pivot tables, XLOOKUP, macros, Power Query), Google Sheets, Power BI, SQL for data analysis (learning), NetSuite ERP, Coupa, SAP, AI tools used daily for analysis and workflow automation (Claude and other assistants), Google Apps Script.

EXPERIENCE

Finance Intern, FP&A (Production), Harbinger Motors

Jun 2026 to Aug 2026

- Delivered monthly financial reporting and budget vs actual variance analysis for the Production organization during a manufacturing ramp, with driver commentary that told operations leaders where cost was moving and why.
- Built cost models from scratch tracking direct and indirect labor, material consumption, inventory movements, and freight and logistics, used by operations as decision-making tools for resource planning as the line scaled.
- Reconciled material demand against inventory supply for monthly production planning, surfacing shortages and excess before they became line stoppages or carrying cost.
- Quantified quality-related and scrap costs and flagged the largest cost focus areas to production leadership so improvement effort went where the money was.
- Investigated cost variances to root cause with manufacturing Engineering, Operations, and Accounting through cross-functional deep dives, fixing data and GL coding at the source so the same exceptions stopped recurring.
- Removed reporting bottlenecks by standardizing templates and automating manual handoffs across NetSuite and Google Sheets, cutting reporting turnaround so decisions moved on current numbers instead of stale ones.
- Automated production cost reporting end to end with Apps Script pipelines from the ERP into Google Sheets, including nightly cost-per-build reporting by revision and program and a weekly hours-per-unit model from raw timesheets that became the direct labor efficiency baseline by assembly.
- Fixed CapEx reconciliation at the root instead of working around it: diagnosed the missing shared identifier between procurement and the ERP, designed a department and area coding scheme, mapped ~2,400 historical PO lines to the capital budget, and wrote the SOP so the manual matching disappears.

Financial Planning and Analysis Specialist, NTT DATA IPS (NTT DATA Group, North America)

Sep 2023 to Aug 2025

- Analyzed KPIs across revenue, cost of sales, operating expenses, and capital expenditures for four business functions, monitoring utilization, margin, cost per unit, productivity, and headcount efficiency and surfacing risks and opportunities to senior leadership without being prompted.
- Ran the monthly rolling financial forecast for operating expenses, capital expenditures, and headcount, updating assumptions as the business moved and delivering consolidated forecasts to finance leadership.
- Owned the annual budget and headcount planning with cross-functional leaders, validating inputs, consolidating submissions, and presenting scenario analyses for resource and investment approvals.
- Built financial models and business-case analyses supporting capital spending and cost management decisions, including a multi-year cost allocation forecasting model built from a blank page.
- Prepared monthly variance analysis against budget and forecast with executive-ready commentary, presenting conclusions and recommendations directly to senior business leaders.
- Drove cost improvement in my own function: identified the automation opportunity, built it with Excel macros, Power BI, and AI-assisted workflows, and cut close and reporting cycle time by 25%; a reconciliation model I built cut discrepancies by 30%.
- Partnered with Accounting and Controllershship through month-end close so forecasts always sat on accurate, reconciled actuals.

Articled Assistant, Audit and Accounting, Sri Ramulu Naidu & Co., Mangalore, India

Sep 2019 to Sep 2022

- Prepared and analyzed complete financial statements (P&L, Balance Sheet, Cash Flow) for multi-entity clients under US GAAP and Ind AS / IFRS, reconciling accounts and analyzing cost structures, margins, and cash flows.
- Reviewed revenue recognition and cost accounting, recommended adjustments, and presented findings to client CFOs and audit committees.
- Managed multiple concurrent engagements with hard statutory deadlines independently, which is where I learned to deliver accurate work under pressure with no one checking behind me.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Financial Close and Reporting Automation, NTT DATA

Jan 2024 to Sep 2024

- Self-initiated Excel and Power BI automation of close data validation and account reconciliation: 30% fewer reconciliation discrepancies, materially faster consolidation, adopted as the team standard.

Multi-Year Cost Allocation Forecasting Model, NTT DATA

Jan 2025 to Aug 2025

- Driver-based multi-year forecasting model built from historical expense data, presented to leadership across historical, budget, and forecast views and used in annual planning.

Labor Productivity Model, Harbinger Motors

Jun 2026 to Aug 2026

- Built an hours-per-unit labor productivity model from raw timesheet data, cleaning and normalizing the underlying dataset to establish consistent employee, job, and work-order groupings before calculations.

EDUCATION AND CREDENTIALS

MS in Finance (STEM), Saint Mary's College of California, Moraga, CA Aug 2026

Coursework: Corporate Finance (NPV, IRR, DCF, business cases), Financial Modeling, Accounting Analytics, Advanced Excel, AI in Finance.

Chartered Accountant, The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) Jul 2023

Auditing, Accounting Standards (Ind AS / IFRS), Financial Management, Taxation.

Bachelor of Commerce (Accounting and Finance), Mangalore University, India Feb 2022

Capstone: Power BI dashboard for expense forecasting and analysis.